

Table of contents

1 Sub-Topic 1: Connecting Metaverse Ethics to Information Ethics (~300 Words)	1
1.1 Node 1.1: The Metaverse as an embodiment space: Datafication vs. Stewardship	1
1.2 Node 1.2: The “NPC-ification” of Real Humans (Digital Metaphysics)	2
1.3 Node 1.3: The Social Complacency of Multiplayer Games & Under The Banality of Virtual Evil	2
2 Sub-Topic 2: Does Violence in MMOGs Impact Real Life? (~300 Words)	3
2.1 Node 2.1: Does Violence in MMOGs Impact Real Life? (~300 Words)	3
2.2 Node 2.2: Satire vs. Atrocity Porn (The Endorsement View) . . .	3
2.3 Node 2.3: Virtue Scaffolding: Games as Moral Gymnasiums . . .	4

NODE MAP OVERVIEW & MULTI-MEDIA BLUEPRINT

1 Sub-Topic 1: Connecting Metaverse Ethics to Information Ethics (~300 Words)

1.1 Node 1.1: The Metaverse as an embodiment space: Datafication vs. Stewardship

- **Provocative Hook:** Is the Metaverse an expansion of human freedom, or a raw data prison?
- **Core Argument & IE Connection:** Information Ethics (IE) views virtual reality as an extension of Floridi’s *infosphere* [@himma2008]. Instead of an amoral playground, users enter as *homo poieticus*—creative stewards duty-bound to prevent informational *entropy* (the degradation of reality and truth)^[1][@himma2008]. The core ethical dilemma is whether the Metaverse fosters human flourishing or commodifies human existence into data streams [capurro2006].
- **Multi-Media Cue:**

- 3D spatial node embedding a split-screen video comparing *Second Life* virtual land speculation with physical environmental degradation^[10][@himma2008].
- Embedded video essay comparing *Second Life* land speculation and data surveillance with real-world corporate monopolies [himma2008].

1.2 Node 1.2: The “NPC-ification” of Real Humans (Digital Metaphysics)

- **Provocative Hook:** If you can torture hyper-realistic AI avatars in VR with zero consequences, how long until you start viewing real humans as disposable NPCs?
- **Core Argument & IE Connection:** Discarding cliché debates about “AI rights,” Capurro critiques “digital metaphysics”—the dangerous tendency to equate human beings with mere data streams [capurro2006]. AI avatars lack noumenal will or embodied consciousness [capurro2006]. The true danger isn’t hurting an AI’s feelings; it is the erosion of *parrhesia* (truth-telling) and human dignity when real people treat the virtual world as a place beyond moral accountability^[1][capurro2006].
- **Multi-Media Cue:** Interactive split-screen node contrasting VR harassment logs with clips from *Westworld* / *Detroit: Become Human*.

1.3 Node 1.3: The Social Complacency of Multiplayer Games & Under The Banality of Virtual Evil

- **Provocative Hook:** How do video game UIs turn ordinary 20-somethings into cold, button-pushing virtual war criminals?
- **Core Argument & IE Connection:** In MMOGs and strategy games (*Defcon*, *EVE Online*), games reward mechanical efficiency (points, numbers going up) while stripping away semantic/emotional feedback [sicart2008][sicart2009]. Sicart calls this the “banality of simulated evil”: when rule engines abstract human suffering into UI metrics, players become unthinking bureaucrats of virtual destruction [sicart2009].
- **Multi-Media Cue:** Audio-visual node playing *Defcon*’s nuclear strikes (minimalist radar + muffled crying audio) alongside real player voice-chats cheering for maximum kill counts [sicart2008].

2 Sub-Topic 2: Does Violence in MMOGs Impact Real Life? (~300 Words)

2.1 Node 2.1: Does Violence in MMOGs Impact Real Life? (~300 Words)

- **Provocative Hook:** Crime rates drop as game sales rise—so why are we still obsessed with virtual slaughter?
- The “contamination thesis” asserts game violence leaks into real-world aggression^[23]^[@goerger2017]. However, macro-data disproves the “contamination thesis” (games do not turn players into real-world mass shooters) ^[@goerger2017]^[@schulzke2010]. However, focusing only on macro-crime ignores the micro-lens: *why* players are drawn to virtual violence. Schulzke and Ostritsch argue games operate inside a “magic circle” where virtual actions lack victims ^[@ostritsch2017]^[@schulzke2010], but the moral question shifts to whether a game *glorifies* depravity or *forces critical reflection* ^[@goerger2017]^[@sicart2009].
- **Multi-Media Cue:** Interactive slider charting video game sales against youth violent crime rates over 30 years (showing inverse correlation)^[45]^[@schulzke2010].

2.2 Node 2.2: Satire vs. Atrocity Porn (The Endorsement View)

- **Provocative Hook:** Why is torturing in *GTA V* satirically defensible, but playing *KZ Manager* morally abhorrent^[18]^[46]^[@ostritsch2017]?
- **Core Argument & Theoretical Connection:** Goerger and Ostritsch argue that graphicness alone does not dictate morality; context and value integration do^[22]^[24]^[@goerger2017]^[47]^[@ostritsch2017]. Under Ostritsch’s *Endorsement View*, representing evil (*GTA V*) is not immoral if framed satirically, whereas endorsing an abhorrent worldview (*KZ Manager*, *Hatred*) violates moral obligations^[18]^[@ostritsch2017].
- **Multi-Media Cue:** Side-by-side gameplay analysis comparing *GTA V*’s satire against *Spec Ops: The Line*’s white phosphorus scene and banned titles ^[@goerger2017]^[@ostritsch2017].

2.3 Node 2.3: Virtue Scaffolding: Games as Moral Gymnasiums

- **Provocative Hook:** Can playing a violent game make you a *more* virtuous person^[21][@schulzke2010]?
- **Core Argument & Theoretical Connection:** Wonderly uses Humean sentimentalism to argue ultra-violent gaming erodes empathy^{[27][50]}[@wonderly2008][@schulzke2010]. Rebutting this, Schulzke demonstrates via Kant that virtual attacks carry no intent to harm real people^[51][@schulzke2010], and via Aristotle that choice-engine games (*Fallout 3*, *The Last of Us*) serve as moral simulators to practice virtuous decision-making^[23][@goerger2017]^{[21][52]}[@schulzke2010].
- **Multi-Media Cue:** Interactive decision-tree node simulating a moral dilemma from *Fallout 3*, showing how moral engines scaffold ethical reflection^[52][@schulzke2010].